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INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

HOLDER, DESK MEMORANDUM PAPER, SHEET TYPE

This Interim Federal Specification was developed by the Standardization Division, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, Washington, D. C. 20406, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers a desk or counter-top holder designed for accommodating 3 x 5 inch sheets of memorandum paper.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

PPP-B-566 - Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-636 - Box, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-665 - Boxes, Paperboard, Metal Stayed (Including Stay Material).
PPP-B-676 - Boxes, Set-up.

Federal Standard:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C., 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D.C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Wash.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

FSC 7520

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(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. The holders shall be made of plastic not less than 0.050 inch thick. The plastic shall retain its design contours without warping, crazing, cracking, softening, or discoloring in normal service and storage. The plastic shall not crack, break, or chip when subjected to the impact test in 4.2.4.1 and shall be nonflammable or shall have a burning rate not exceeding 3.0 inches per minute when tested in accordance with 4.2.4.2.

3.2 Design and construction. The holder shall be designed to accommodate, in loose-leaf form, 3 x 5 inch sheets of paper up to at least 1/2 inch in total thickness. The inside length and width dimensions of the holder shall be adequate to insure compactness of the sheets without causing them to be cramped. The design shall allow for easy insertion and removal of sheets of paper. The holder shall have a top piece (the top being the highest portion of the holder when it lays flat on a level surface) located at one width-end to provide protection against disarrangement of the sheets from wind gusts, handling, or other means. The design shall allow at least 2/3 of the writing portion of the top sheet to remain exposed. At the width-end opposite the top piece, a thumb notch or other suitable arrangement shall be provided to facilitate easy insertion and removal of papers.

3.3 Color. The holders shall be gray in color.

3.4 Finish. The holder shall have a smooth, uniform surface and shall be free from cold bonds, delaminations, porosity, warpage, checks, cracks, chips, blisters, scratches, rough edges, or sharp protrusions.

3.5 Identification marking. The holder shall be permanently and legibly marked with the manufacturer's name or trademark.

3.6 Workmanship. The holder shall be free from defects which affect appearance or which may affect serviceability.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Sampling and inspection.

4.2.1 Lot. For purposes of sampling for inspection, a lot shall consist of all holders offered for acceptance at one time.

4.2.2 For visual and functional. Examine sample holders for defects listed in table I. Insert and remove several 3 x 5 inch sheets of paper in conjunction with this examination. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105, inspection level S-3 with an acceptable quality level (AQL) of 4.0 defects per hundred units. The sample unit shall be one holder.

Table I. Inspection of visual and functional defects.

Examine	Defects
Material	Not plastic; not thickness specified.
Design and construction	Does not hold 3 x 5 inch loose sheets of paper up to at least 1/2 inch in total thickness; less than 2/3 of writing portion of top sheet exposed; inside dimensions

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Table I. Inspection of visual and functional defects. (Cont'd)

Examine	Defects
Design and construction	too large allowing sheets to shift back and forth, or too small, causing binding or cramping of sheets; design does not allow for easy insertion or removal of sheets; holder not equipped with a top piece at one width-end for protection against disarrangement of sheets; thumb notch or other suitable arrangement not provided at width-end opposite top piece.
Color	Not gray.
Finish	Does not have smooth, uniform surface; not free from cold bonds, delaminations, porosity, warpage, checks, cracks, chips, blisters, scratches, rough edges, or sharp protrusions.
Identification marking	Holder not permanently and legibly marked with the manufacturer's name or trademark.
Workmanship	Any defect which affects appearance or which may affect serviceability.

4.2.3 For delivery. An inspection shall be made to determine that the packaging, packing, and marking comply with the requirements in section 5 of this specification. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table II. For examination of interior packaging the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery, selected at random just prior to the closing operations. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. Defects of closure listed shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 defects per hundred units.

Table II. Inspection of preparation for delivery defects.

Examine	Defects
Markings (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, or distortion of container.
Contents (exterior and interior container)	Number per container is more or less than required. Net weight exceeds requirements.

4.2.4 Tests. Sample holders shall be subjected to the following tests. Sampling for tests shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105, inspection level S-2, with an AQL of 4.0 defects per hundred units. The sample unit shall be one holder.

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4.2.4.1 Impact test. Drop the holder on a concrete floor 5 times from a height of 4 feet. Position the holder so it will hit the floor at a different angle each drop. After the fifth drop examine the holder for compliance with 3.1.

4.2.4.2 Flammability. Cut a piece approximately 3 inches long and 1/2 inch wide from the sample holder. In a draft free area, hold the plastic specimen horizontally above a bunsen burner having a 1 to 1-1/4 inch blue flame just touching the end of the specimen until it ignites, or for a period not over 30 seconds. Remove the flame. If the specimen will not support combustion it is nonflammable. If the specimen burns, measure the burning rate in inches per minute and check for compliance with 3.1.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A. Twelve holders of like description shall be packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-566, PPP-B-665, or PPP-B-676.

5.1.2 Level B. The holders shall be packaged as specified in 5.1.1.

5.1.3 Level C. The holders shall be packaged to afford adequate protection against deterioration and damage during shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity. The supplier's commercial practice will be acceptable when it fulfills the above requirements.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A. Twelve unit packages of holders of like description shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. The box shall be closed and strapped in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Twelve unit packages of holders of like description shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. The holders shall be packed to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination at the lowest rates, in containers complying with the rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Standard packaging (civil agencies). The standard packaging and packing for civil agencies shall be as specified in 5.1.2 and 5.2.2 respectively.

5.4 Marking.

5.4.1 Civil agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.4.2 Military activities. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Selection of applicable level of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).

DOD coordination has been waived.

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